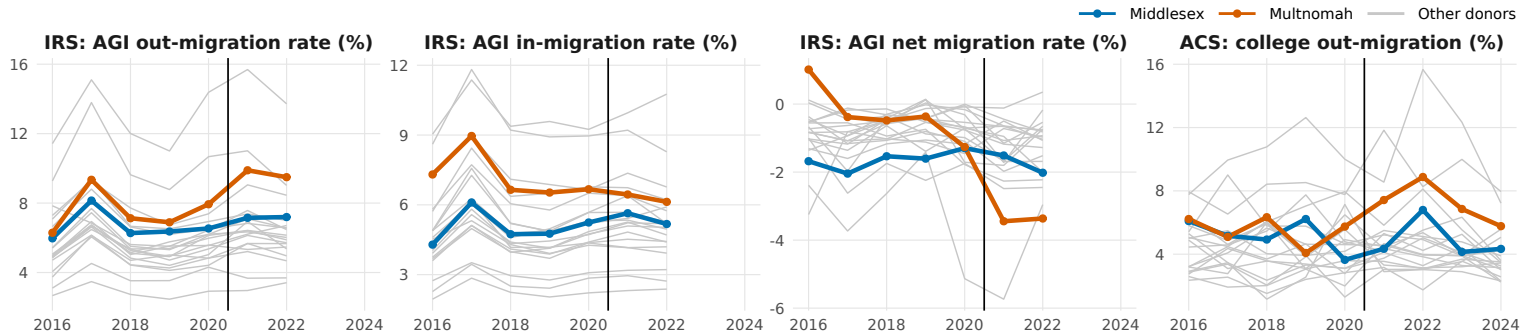
Middlesex County, New Jersey

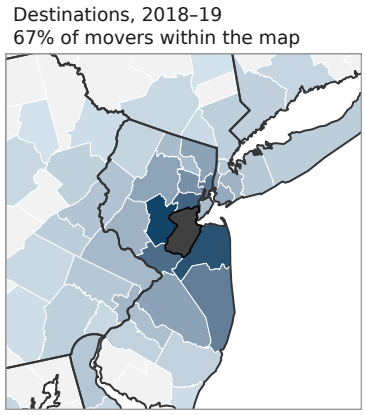
Not used as a placebo: fails the IRS-trend screen (b)

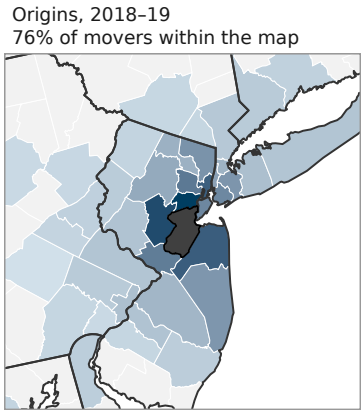
→ = 2018–19 to 2021–22 average	Middlesex	Multnomah	Screens; College × Post DiD	This county	Multnomah
Population, 2020 Census	863,162	815,428	Used as a placebo (both screens)?	NO	
Density (people per sq. mile)	2,791	1,891	Origin county identified in the ACS?	yes	
Urban share of population	99%	99%	(a) Own pre-trend, joint p-value	0.45 — pass	0.39
Median household income (ACS)	$89,533	$69,176	(b) IRS slope distance from Multnomah	0.47 — FAIL	cutoff 0.43
Share under 24 / 65 and over	31% / 15%	27% / 13%	rank among donors (1 = closest)	12 of 20	
State top income-tax rate, 2019 / 2020 (%)	10.75 / 10.75	9.90 / 9.90	AGI out / in slope, 2016–19 (pp/yr)	-0.07 / 0.00	-0.04 / -0.46
Governor's party, 2019 / 2020	D / D	D / D	In NJ or NY (top-rate rises 2020–21)?	YES	
Days under stay-at-home order	80	88	Other donor pools	stringency; demog.	
IRS AGI out-migration rate (%)	6.32 → 7.17	7.01 → 9.69	DiD, out-migration: pp (se)	0.24 (0.50)	1.88 (0.57)
IRS AGI in-migration rate (%)	4.75 → 5.41	6.59 → 6.29	DiD, out-of-state: pp (se)	0.02 (0.33)	1.34 (0.44)
IRS AGI net migration rate (%)	-1.57 → -1.77	-0.42 → -3.40	DiD, in-migration: pp (se)	-0.0013 (0.0019)	-0.0028 (0.0020)

Migration rates before and after 2020

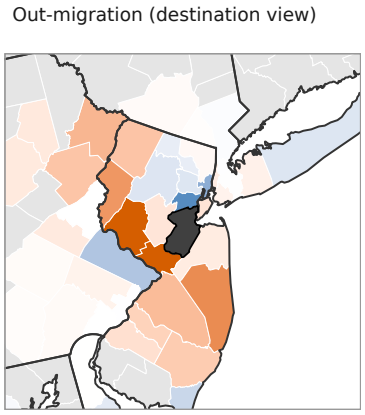


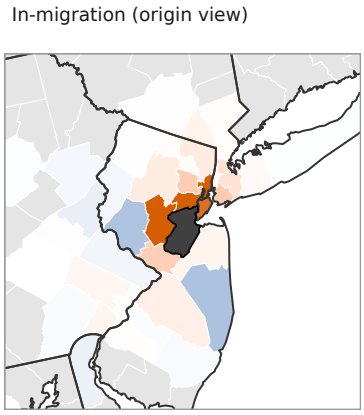
Where its movers went and came from





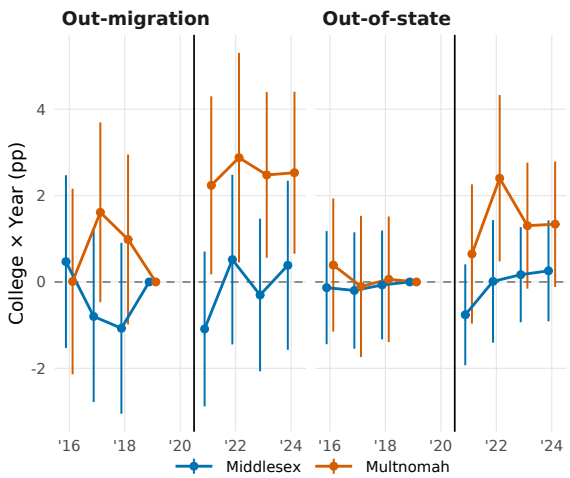
Change in AGI flows, 2018–19 to 2021–22 (as Figure 6)





% of movers	2018–19	2021–22	% of movers	2018–19	2021–22	Mult. pre	Mult. post
Top destinations			**Out-movers, to:**				
Somerset, NJ	10.9	10.9	Border county	33	32	46	43
Monmouth, NJ	9.0	8.1	Within state	54	54	47	45
Union, NJ	6.8	6.0	Bordering state	13	13	27	27
Mercer, NJ	5.9	6.0	Top 10 flows	50	49	56	54
Hudson, NJ	4.7	4.3	**In-movers, from:**				
Top origins			Border county	37	36	35	34
Union, NJ	11.8	12.2	Within state	57	58	39	39
Somerset, NJ	9.8	8.5	Bordering state	19	22	28	30
Monmouth, NJ	7.6	7.4	Top 10 flows	58	61	48	48
Hudson, NJ	7.3	8.4					
Essex, NJ	4.8	5.6					

Placebo event study (base 2019, 95% CI)



Sources: IRS SOI county migration files by filing year (rates as % of the county's base-year AGI; mover shares use returns); ACS 1-year PUMS, adults 25+.
Bordering-state shares are lower bounds (IRS disclosure). Change maps: grey = no flow reported in one or both windows.
DiD: 02_did_placebo.do, College × Year with the county as the focal county, 2016–2024 without 2020; bars are 95% confidence intervals.